WEEK 4 · LESSON 20 OF 24 · HANDOUT

Working Responsibly with AI

Study time: **about 40 minutes** (reading, video and activity)

▶ **Watch:** https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UG_X_7g63rY — open the lesson online to watch inside the course.

🎓 **Go deeper:** Crash Course AI: Algorithmic Bias and Fairness — https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gV0_raKR2UQ

Your goal in this lesson: Recognise bias and fairness problems, use AI honestly in study and work, and apply a simple responsible-use checklist.

Bias: when patterns become unfair

AI learns from data made by people, and that data contains people's history — including unfairness. If a hiring tool learns from years of past decisions that favoured one group, it may repeat that pattern. If a face-recognition system was trained mostly on lighter-skinned faces, it may work worse for darker-skinned people — a problem researchers like Joy Buolamwini have shown clearly.

Bias matters most when AI affects people's **opportunities**: jobs, loans, admissions, healthcare, justice.

What you can do: - Ask *"Who could this treat unfairly?"* before using AI in decisions about people. - Check results across different groups, not just on average. - Keep a human decision-maker who can listen and correct.

Honesty and transparency

- **Be open** about AI use when it matters: if your employer, client or lecturer asks, tell the truth about how you used AI.
- **Do not pass off AI work as purely your own** where that is not allowed.
- **Do not deceive**: no fake reviews, fake testimonials, fake images of real people, or messages pretending to be someone else.

Academic integrity

Each institution sets its own rules on AI. Generally:

Usually acceptable (check your rules)	Usually NOT acceptable
Explaining a concept you are studying	Submitting AI-written work as your own
Brainstorming topics and questions	Inventing data or references
Checking grammar and clarity	Using AI in exams or tests without permission
Making revision questions	Hiding AI use when asked to declare it

When unsure, **ask your lecturer** — and keep notes of how you used AI.

Over-reliance

If you always let AI think for you, your own skills weaken. Protect your growth:

- Do the core thinking yourself, use AI to speed up and check.
- Regularly practise skills without AI — writing, calculating, problem solving.

A responsible-use checklist: S-A-F-E

- **S**ources checked — facts verified.
- **A**ffected people considered — could anyone be treated unfairly?
- **F**air and honest — no deception; AI use disclosed when required.
- **E**ncrypted / private — no personal or confidential data exposed.

Remember this: Responsible AI use means checking for bias, being honest about how you used AI, protecting people's data and keeping your own skills strong.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Activity

Task 1

Think of a decision about people in your field (hiring, admissions, lending, grading, customer service).

Task 2

Describe how an AI tool could help — and how it could be **unfair**.

Task 3

Write 3 safeguards you would put in place.

Task 4

Read your institution's or employer's AI policy (if one exists) and summarise its main rules in 5 bullet points.

Self-check

Think about your answers here, then take the quiz online — it is marked instantly and explains every answer.

1. How does bias usually enter an AI system?
   - A. AI chooses to be unfair
   - B. Bias cannot exist in AI
   - C. Through patterns in training data that reflect past unfairness or missing groups
   - D. Through slow internet
2. When does AI bias matter MOST?
   - A. When translating a menu
   - B. When writing a poem
   - C. When choosing a font
   - D. When AI affects people's opportunities like jobs, loans or healthcare
3. Which use of AI in study is usually NOT acceptable?
   - A. Asking it to explain a concept
   - B. Submitting AI-written work as entirely your own when that is not allowed
   - C. Making revision questions
   - D. Checking grammar
4. What does the S in the S-A-F-E checklist stand for?
   - A. Speed
   - B. Software
   - C. Style
   - D. Sources checked
5. What is a good way to avoid over-reliance on AI?
   - A. Stop learning new skills
   - B. Let AI think for you every time
   - C. Use more AI tools
   - D. Do the core thinking yourself and practise skills without AI regularly
6. Your lecturer's AI rules are unclear. What should you do?
   - A. Use AI secretly
   - B. Avoid the assignment
   - C. Ask your lecturer and keep notes of how you used AI
   - D. Guess and hope

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